

IX.1979

F L E A N E W S

No.16

Compiled by the Custodian of the Rothschild Collection of
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of Science and Technology

Please find herewith lists of additional literature for 1974 (list 10),
1975 (list 11), 1978 (list 4) and 1979 (list 2).

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With deep regret the death is announced of our colleagues

Dr Boris Aleksandrovich ROSTIGAYEV, Stavropol', U.S.S.R. (died 10.VI.1979)

Mr Gordon B. THOMPSON, Cambridge, U.K. (died VI.1979)

* * *

..... yet another PRICE INCREASE of Volumes I - V of the Catalogue of
the Rothschild Collection of Fleas, by Hopkins & Rothschild -
the revised prices are: Vol. I: £13.00 Vol. II: £16.50 Vol. III: £19.50
Vol. IV: £28.50 Vol. V: £34.00. That makes £111.50 for the five volumes
together, i.e. at the moment

* * *

Congratulations to Dr George P. HOLLAND to whom the "Gold Medal for
Outstanding Achievements in Canadian Entomology, 1979" has been awarded by
the Entomological Society of Canada. Happily, the award will be presented
in Dr Holland's old home town of Vancouver in October 1979.

Most of us will know Dr Holland especially through his truly exemplary
publications on fleas but actually his activities and achievements are
manifold [and even include carving of totem-poles, playing the accordion
and having one of Canada's beauty queens as daughter].

I like to remember how awestruck I was when, during a visit to Tring
Museum in 1948, Dr Jordan showed me a carbon copy of the text and photocopies
of the plates for GPH's "The Siphonaptera of Canada" (1949); especially the
illustrations seemed to set a new, higher, standard. His work certainly has
been an inspiration to me. Over the years Dr Holland's draughtsmanship has
even further developed and we are now eagerly looking forward to his entirely
re-written "Siphonaptera of Canada, Alaska and Greenland" which will form
a truly fitting monument to GPH's achievements in entomological research
and inspire - or put to shame - many a future student of fleas.

F.S.

* * *

A REQUEST - With reference to my note in the previous Flea News I have
pleasure in informing you that I have now almost finished the first draft
for subfamily Rhopalopsyllinae. You are therefore invited to send me any
(awkward) well-mounted specimens for determination or checking (no large
quantities, please) or to donate material to our collection for listing
in Volume VII of the Flea Catalogue. It concerns the following genera:
Rhopalopsyllus, Tiamastus, Polygenis and Scolopsyllus.

F.G.A.M.Smit

* * *

MAILING LIST

Change:

Dr V. S. Vashchyonok - Institute of Zoology, Academy of Sciences,
Universitetskaya naberezhnaya 1, Leningrad V 164, U.S.S.R.

ANOTHER NON-JUMPER - As referred to in Flea News 14, Barnes et al. (1977) reported that fleas of the genus Anomiopsyllus do not jump at all. In view of the remarkable leaping ability of fleas in general, it seems strange to find a flea that does not jump; but - this is not the only one.

In our laboratory we have been studying the life histories of several species of fleas which infest the southern flying squirrel, Glaucomys volans, among them another member of Anomiopsyllinae, namely Conorhinopsylla stanfordi Stewart. This species, too, is apparently quite incapable of jumping. Indeed, when we remove a group of fleas from the nest we can often recognize this species because of its failure to attempt to escape by leaping. We have put both males and females on a table and poked them with forceps, but they respond simply by crawling away. We have never been able to persuade one to jump.

We have also discovered another unusual feature of C. stanfordi. The eggs have a reticulated surface strongly reminiscent of the multi-faceted compound eye of an insect. The egg of this species can instantly be recognized under a binocular dissecting microscope because of this remarkable superficial feature. [Similar surface patterns are found on eggs of several other Hystrihopsyllid fleas such as certain Stenoponia and Sphinctopsylla. - F.S.]

Allen H. Benton & Michael Surman
(Fredonia, N.Y., U.S.A.)

* * *

K. JORDAN BIBLIOGRAPHY - Recently an omission was noticed in this list (sent with Flea News 11), the overlooked title being:

1930b (15.IV) - The President's Address. PE 4(3): 128-142, figs. 1-6, pl. III. (Siph.: 136, 140, figs. 1-6).

(This paper is not very important as far as fleas are concerned [note the great similarity of title and pagination to item 1931a]).

Item 1930b (15.XI) should be altered to 1930c.

In the bibliography the remark should have been made that joint papers with N.C. Rothschild are listed in the N. C. Rothschild bibliography (sent with Flea News 10).

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SUGGESTIONS (or wishful thinking) -

"Pas de bonne figure, pas de nom valable." - Ch. Oberthür

"Pas de bonnes figures de l'appareil reproducteur, pas de nom valable."

K. Jordan

That would be marvellous. It may be remarked that in spite of the general good standard of illustration - there are ample examples of the quality required - the Siphonapterological literature is still being marred by poor or appallingly poor line drawings or poorly reproduced good ones (usually by being over-reduced in size). Editors, by accepting (i.e., not recognizing) rubbishy drawings or by squeezing too many figures on to a page, are mainly to be blamed for this. But of course . . . those who cannot, or will not, draw well - and cannot afford the services of a suitable draughtsman - should refrain from doing taxonomic work where so much depends on first-class illustrations.

F.S.

* * *

" . . . in these dark days . . . perhaps now as never before we need to recognise and encourage the skill of the individual, be he painter, be he writer, carpenter or engraver, before we are overtaken by the very real danger that such skills may be lost in the medley of mediocrity by which the world is being overwhelmed."

LITERATURE ON SIPHONAPTERA PUBLISHED IN 1974 (list 10)

- Ageyev, V.S., Trofimov, V.I. & Pavlova, A.Ye. - Fleas of gerbils in the Ural valley and some data on their spatial distribution. Mater. VIII Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. sredn. Azii Kazakhstana: 301-303.
- Asenov, G.A., Palvaniyazov, M., Kairov, I.Kh. & Petrov, L.N. - Parasites of predatory animals in south Cis-Aral. Vestn. Karakalp. Fil. A. N. Uzbek.SSR 2:30-34.
- Asenov, G.A., Petrov, L.N., Chumachenko, V.D., Pirnazarov, Ye. & Paluaniyazov, T.P. - Fleas of terrestrial predatory animals in the territory of north-western Kyzylkumy. Mater. VIII protivochumn. Uchrezh. sredn. Azii Kazakhstana: 305-307.
- Asenov, G.A., Petrov, L.N., Paluaniyazov, T.P., Chumachenko, V.D., Sokolova, T.Yu. & Burkulov, K.B. - Fleas of the slender-clawed suslik in north-western Kyzylkumy. Mater. VIII Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. sredn. Azii Kazakhstana: 303-305.
- Beier, A.P., Akiyev, A.K. & Suvorova, A.Ye. - The morphology of the virulent plague microbe in the organism of the flea *Xenopsylla cheopis*. Probl. osobo opasn. Infektsii, Saratov 6(40): 60-63.
- Bryukhanova, L.V. & Myalkovskaya, S.A. - On the periodicity of the metamorphosis of fleas in nests of the small suslik. Tez. Dokl. III Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. Kavkaza 1: 121-124.
- Bykov, L.T. & Chyornonog, H.F. - Rodents and their ectoparasites in the environs of the Chardarin reservoir. Mater. VIII Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. sredn. Azii Kazakhstana: 244-245.
- Darskaya, N.F. & Karandina, R.S. - Observations on the development of the immature stages of *Neopsylla setosa* Wagn., 1898, a suslik flea. Tez. Dokl. III Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. Kavkaza 1: 134-137.
- Dyatlova, T.I. & Korneyeva, L.A. - The influence of rearing conditions on the modification of morpho-physiological characters of the oriental rat flea (*Xenopsylla cheopis*). Mater. VII S'yezda Vsyev. ent. Obshch. 1: 222-223.
- Gershkovich, N.L. & Naumov, R.L. - Fleas (Siphonaptera) of small mammals and passerine birds in the focus of tick-encephalitis in western Sayan. Byull. Mosk. Obshch. Ispyt. Prir. (Biol.) 79(2): 39-49.
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- Khodykina, Z.S. - The fat body of the rat fleas *Xenopsylla cheopis* and *Ceratophyllus fasciatus*. Mater. VII S'yezda Vsyev. ent. Obshch. 1: 263-264.
- Konnov, N.P., Anisimov, P.I., Kondrashkina, K.I., Sinichkina, A.A., Luk'yanova, A.D. & Demchenko, T.A. - Electron-microscopic examination of the proventriculus of fleas (*Xenopsylla cheopis*) blocked by plague microbes. Probl. osobo opasn. Infektsii, Saratov 4(38): 41-48.
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- Lysenko, L.S., Morozkina, Ye.A. & Kafarskaya, D.G. - Fleas of some mammals of the Gissar mountains. Mater. VIII Konfer. protivochumn. Uchrezh. sredn. Azii Kazakhstana: 333-335.
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- It will be understood that -although their titles are given in English in these lists- papers in Russian or Chinese periodicals are in Russian or Chinese but often with summaries in English.